

Chapter

The Power of Collectivity — Society First, Wealth Follows



Introduction: The Six "S"s and the First Among Them

This is a short but deeply practical teaching. Acharya Upendra Ji lists **artha** — worldly prosperity — in six words, and then asks which of them comes first:

"Sampatti (wealth), samman (respect), samaj (society), stri (spouse), samay (time), swasthya (health) — that is 'artha'. And of these, the first is samaj — society."

His message is direct: wealth, business, even a guru's work — everything grows when people connect. And people connect through **daivi sampatti** — the divine qualities described in the sixteenth chapter of the Shrimad Bhagavad Gita.

1. Society Connects Through Speech

Who does society connect with? Acharya Ji's answer: the one who has **vani** — the art of communication:

"The one who has vani — communication, meaning whether it is chat, body language, or speaking face to face — doesn't society connect properly with such a person?"

Speech here does not mean only talking. The written message, the language of the body, the face-to-face conversation — together these decide whether people come closer to us or move away.

And once this connection is made, everything else becomes easy:

"And once that society is properly connected, how difficult will business be? Wealth then comes on its own, later."

Instead of chasing wealth, build genuine connection with people; wealth is its natural result.

2. Divine Qualities in Business: Conversation, Not Conflict

How does this principle show up in everyday business? Acharya Ji gives the example of a trader and a customer:

"The one who has daivi sampatti — even with a customer, his dispute ends quickly; otherwise it goes on in court for ten years."

A person with divine qualities does not turn a dispute into a matter of ego. He finds a way through conversation:

"Come, I'll give you a little more. Take a sample. This time's order is cancelled? Alright, fine — next time I'll deliver it right.' Some of it simply ends in the conversation itself."

On the other hand:

"If he fights, it will take much more of his time, won't it?"

Generosity and flexibility are not weakness — they save time, relationships and business, all three.

3. Even a Guru Grows Through Society

The same rule applies in the spiritual world. Acharya Ji makes clear that a guru becoming "big" is not a question of power but of work:

"Anywhere — whether it is a guru, or guru and disciple — only when that society grows will the guru also become big."

"Not in the sense of the guru being big from the angle of power — his work becomes big when his society connects."

From this he draws the conclusion:

"So definitely, what comes before daivi sampatti?
Society."

Knowledge spreads only as far as the people who connect with it. Collectivity is the strength of any work.

4. How Big Is Your "World"?

The size of society can be different for each person. Acharya Ji calls it one's **vishva** — one's world, the circle one has taken responsibility for:

"Society means one's whole family — it need not be always in size."

For some, this world is small:

"Some husband says, 'I want only this much as my world.' Fine, isn't it? But that world too will have to be run with these qualities."

For others, it is the whole planet:

"Someone else will say, 'I want to build a big world organisation like the World Health Organization, I want to do something for world peace.' Then for him, the whole world has become his world. So he will have to apply this daivi sampatti that far."

Whether your circle is one family or the whole earth, the qualities that run it are the same. The bigger your world, the more widely you must live the divine qualities.

Summary: Key Teachings

- 1** Artha has six parts — wealth, respect, society, spouse, time, health — and the first of them is **society**.

- 2 Society connects through speech** — chat, body language and face-to-face conversation, every form of communication.
- 3 Once society connects, business becomes easy**, and wealth then comes on its own.
- 4 Divine qualities settle disputes through conversation**; fighting only destroys time and relationships.
- 5 A guru's greatness lies not in power but in work** — and the work grows only when society connects.
- 6 Everyone has their own "world"** — from a family to the whole planet — and it must be run with divine qualities.